

EFFECTIVE USAGE AND CHALLENGES TO ACCESS E- RESOURCES AMONG RESEARCH SCHOLARS IN BISHOP HEBER COLLEGE TRICHY: A STUDY

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ABSTRACT

Electronic resources are digital materials that may be accessed over the internet. The advancement of computer and network technology is changing the educational pattern and moving the teaching and learning process from a traditional physical setting to a digital environment. Technological advancement has resulted in the creation of electronic forms of information, which has subsequently rejuvenated the information processing and access process. Electronic resources have significant benefits over traditional print resources in that they can be accessed at any time, from any location, using electronic devices such as computers, tablets, smartphones, and e-book readers. Users like exercising and exploring features such as simple handling, compact size, personalization, and access to digital resources at any time and from any location. Electronic information resources have had a considerable impact on users' information retrieval behaviours and perspectives. E-resources are becoming an essential component of academic library collections. The move from print to electronic resources has resulted in substantial changes for libraries and their users.

The term "electronic resources" has been generally defined as material accessed by a computer; they may be valuable as bibliographic clues to possible sources, but they are rarely acknowledged as references in their own right. The Internet efficiently and effectively meets information demands and retrieval of information. Libraries have implemented new transformational strategies in their collection development and service organizations to better the management of academic "information." This is also necessary for strengthening and quickly accessing scholarly knowledge that is not stored locally. "The NIFT libraries are largely utilized for research work, thus they must transition to e-resources, which are less expensive and more beneficial for simple access.

This paper presents and analyses the various aspects of E-Resources and its effective usage of E-Resources among the Research scholars in Bishop Heber College Trichy, and it also helps in finding out the challenges to access the e-resources among the research scholars. The findings will be useful for librarians and faculty in highlighting the usage of digital library. Finally, it reports the results from the structured questionnaire- based survey method which has 89 questionnaires were distributed to the research scholars of Bishop Heber College from which 76 (85%) questionnaires were received back by the researcher. Finally, it helps to find out the usage among the Research Scholars and its effectiveness.

Key words :

E-resources, Challenges, Research Scholars, Effective usage.

1. INTRODUCTION

An E- resource is defined as any electronic product that delivers a collection of data, whether it is text referring to full text bases, E-journals, image collections, other multimedia products, numerical, graphical, or time based, as a commercially available title that has been published with the intent of being marketed. E-Journals, E-Books, E-Databases, E- Magazines, E-Thesis, E-News Papers, E-Dictionaries, E-Encyclopedia, abstract, full-text documents and digital collections, online databases, and web sites that serve as an alternative to print media are examples of E-Resources. This noteworthy fact has prompted several libraries to do research demonstrating that frequent usage of e-journals and e-books ranks among arts users.

Recent academic libraries have a collection of printed books and periodicals, as well as electronic resources where both types of publications may be kept, accessed, and supplied as needed. The library should have a sufficient quantity of resources for teaching, learning, and research. E- resources provide innovative opportunities for expanding access, sharing, and publication in academic activity. The contents of E-Resources may be read on personal computers at any time and from any location. E-books will never go out of print, and new versions will be simple to develop.

The introduction of electronic media has resulted in an increase in user demands due to the explosion of information. Due to an increase in academic journal subscription fees and a drop in funds, educational institutes are finding it difficult to meet the expectations of their stakeholders. The Indian higher education system is one of the world's largest. India has 892 universities and 42338 colleges. To meet the demands of these higher education establishments, the Government of India is making every effort to improve educational quality by providing necessary resources. In order to address the budgetary demands of the less fortunate academic brotherhood, the University Grants Commission, New Delhi, launched a significant program called INFLIBNET in 1991.

It became an autonomous Inter university center (IUC) in 1996, and since then it has been active in upgrading libraries and information centers throughout India and linking them via a countrywide high-speed digital network. Consortia are growing forms of collaboration among libraries that join together to exchange resources. In December 2015, three consortiums merged to establish e-Shodh Sindhu: the UGC-Infonet Digital Library Consortium, the INDEST-AICTE Consortium, and the National Library & Information Services Infrastructure for Scholarly Content. It continues to deliver over 15000 core and

peer-reviewed journals, bibliographic, citation, and factual databases to centrally sponsored technical institutes, universities, and colleges covered by UGC Acts 12 (B) and 2. (f). The current study is being conducted to examine college students' use of e-resources via the N-LIST program.

The use of technology in higher education has two direct effects on academic libraries: altering material forms and scholarly communication possibilities, and changing how knowledge is distributed outside of the classroom environment (Wood & Walther, 2000). Web sites, online databases, e-journals, e-books, and physical carriers in various forms are examples of electronic resources. Whether free or paid, networked electronic resources have become an essential aspect of the academic library during the last decade. Electronic resources have the ability to expand the learning possibilities available to students. In particular, the interactive and multimedia features supplied by the electronic medium can give a greater diversity of learning experiences than text on paper. As a result, it is past time for Indian information professionals to investigate the several important characteristics of electronic resources and successfully channel them into the curious minds of users by recognizing and addressing some of the challenges associated with the usage of e-resources.

In the past, libraries were more commonly referred to as book stores. Because of the advancement of information technology, the concept of libraries has completely transformed. This IT world is moving at a breakneck pace. The confluence of information technology has a significant influence on libraries. The Library duties that were formerly carried out manually with much pain and stress are now carried out efficiently and with little effort thanks to IT. Academic libraries are an essential component of higher education institutions, serving two complimentary functions: first, to support the curriculum, and second, to assist faculty and student research. Rapid improvements in modern technology have substantially increased the ability of libraries to store, analyze, retrieve, and manage the enormous expansion of information. In reality, libraries are operating in an ever-changing environment, dealing with numerous developments such as the IT revolution, information explosion, and slashed library funding, as well as a high degree of user acceptance and information resources available in many forms of media. In today's world, the amount to which a library uses IT to offer its services determines its success.

With its expansion, libraries are preparing to employ their technology to provide information rapidly. Libraries employ information technology to improve services and

meet the different demands of its users. It has a significant influence on all facets of the current library environment. Nowadays, library automation and the internet have transformed information access and library operations all over the world. Libraries have evolved into digital and virtual libraries, with books, journals, and magazines being replaced by e-books, e-journals, and e-zines. As a result, electronic resources are becoming an increasingly essential component of library collection development initiatives.

Electronic resources, according to the International Federation of Library Associations and Institutions (IFLA), are materials that need computer access, whether by a personal computer, mainframe, or any mobile device. E-journals, e-books, full text databases, indexing and abstracting databases, reference databases (bibliographies, dictionaries, directories, encyclopedias, etc.), numeric and statistical databases, e-images, e-audio/visual resources are some of the most commonly encountered. Access to a computer, whether by a personal computer, mainframe, or handled mobile device. E-journals, e-books, full text databases, indexing and abstracting databases, reference databases (bibliographies, dictionaries, directories, encyclopedias, etc.), numeric and statistical databases, e-images, e-audio/visual resources are some of the most commonly encountered.

The library is critical to the spread of education throughout society. Particularly when it comes to academic libraries, their importance is growing. Previously, a library was just recognized as a storehouse of books where materials were only stored and no one could use them, but as time passes, libraries are revitalizing the current demand. Because of the rapid advancement of information and communication technology, libraries are increasingly becoming electronic, with content kept in electronic formats that all users may access at any time. There is no separation between libraries and locations. In the current scenario, every location has libraries, and every library has a location. In this context, E-resources are a critical component in the creation of concepts since every location has libraries and every library has a place. Because of the 24*7 accessibility of e-resources, e-resources play a significant role in increasing user happiness. It is really simple to use, share, and download. Many different forms of E-resources are now available on the internet. Some of them are publicly available, while others are subscription-based minimum-charge services supplied by a variety of vendors.

2. REVIEW OF LITERATURE

Charles (2022) investigated the relationship between the impact of electronic resources and their utilization in Coimbatore managing institution libraries. This is a quantitative approach-based study that used a questionnaire to collect data and information. A legitimate response rate of 76% was discovered. The survey method was employed in this study, with the majority of data collected by questionnaire. The data was analyzed using SPSS software in terms of descriptive elements, and a five-point Likert scale was utilized. The study is significant because it will help to enhance awareness of the significance of e-resources as academic tools. Another reason for the study's importance is that it investigates the purposes for which academia in higher education uses eresources, therefore adding to knowledge in those fields.

Balasubramanian and Shahnaz (2021) investigated social, political, and economic cultural tendencies. University Libraries have recently updated outmoded mission statements with a fresh vision of modernizing e-resources. University libraries are the focal point for both the university's instructional operations and the academic activity of all affiliated schools. Their mission is to support students', faculty's, researchers', and academics' learning and research activities by purchasing and making available the best print and electronic materials available. ICT breakthroughs have impacted publication practices, the information landscape, educational perspectives, and demographics. University libraries must evolve in order to fulfill their goals and explain their roles in order to remain relevant and valuable to their audiences.

Tripathi, Sonkar, and Rajbanshi, (2020) assessed the usage and effect of e-resources among research scholars in Uttar Pradesh Agriculture and Technology Universities. A survey was carried out, and data was collected and analyzed using the appropriate procedures. The study concentrated on the purpose of utilizing e-resources, techniques for seeking and browsing e-resources, research scholar satisfaction, and difficulties. The findings have resulted in recommendations for making the best use of e-resources and providing clients with effective and efficient library services.

Verma, and Ahmad (2020) investigated e-resource usage, the relationship of access points with devices for accessing e-resources, and the impact of e-resource use on academic efficiency of faculty and technical staff at India's first Agricultural University, Govind Ballabh Pant University of Agriculture and Technology, Pantnagar, India. The study also demonstrated user utilization levels of various types of e-resources when access points are associated with devices used, as well as the influence of e-resources on academic efficiency. As a data gathering tool, a questionnaire was employed. The utilization of e-resources was investigated using a response scaling approach based on Likert Scales. Scale rating was used to turn the acquired data into scores. For the examination of variance and correlation, standard statistical procedures were applied.

Sawai, Amol Babasaheb, Chavan, and Subhash Pundalikrao (Jan 2020) established the knowledge and usage of e-resources such as E-Journals, E-Books, CD/DVDs, OPAC, E-Databases, and Internet, among others, at various Marath Wada college libraries. A survey was used to acquire primary data from 210 respondents. The information was gathered using a questionnaire and analyzed using SSPS and Microsoft Excel. According to the findings, 102 (48.57 percent) of respondents frequented the library on a daily basis. It was also discovered that the majority of respondents (189, or 24.60 percent) used E-Journals. A total of 145 respondents (69.04 percent) had outstanding understanding of using e-resources. The majority of 198 respondents (46.47 percent) used e-resources for research purposes. The majority of 155 respondents (47.11 percent) believe that slow internet speed is the problem.

3. RESEARCH METHODOLOGY

The chapter deals with methodology in the research that has been adopted for the study. The research methodology includes the aim and objective of the study, Significance of the study, Hypothesis, Research design, Questionnaire and chapterization of the study.

Research Design

Research is an intensive study in a particular field to achieve at a better conclusion of a problem. Research methodology is a systematic way of solving the problem. The research design is the basic framework or a plan for a study that guides the collection of the data analysis of data.

Method of Data Collection

Structured questionnaire method has been adopted for the present study. The study consists of a total of thirty nine questions divided into two major parts. Part I deals with demographic details and Part II deals with the usage of e-resources: Advantages, Types, Preference, Purpose, Awareness, challenges to , and Effectiveness. There are 89 questionnaires distributed to the research scholars of Bishop Heber College from which 76 (85%) questionnaires were received back by the researcher.

Aim of the study

The aim of the study is to find the “Usage of E-resources among Research Scholars in Bishop Heber College Trichy : A Study”

Objectives

1. To find the purpose of using e-resources among the research scholars in Bishop Heber College
2. To know the Barriers as Challenges to access the e-resources among the research scholars
3. To access the Advantages of e-resources among research scholars
4. To evaluate the effective usage of e-resources on the research quality of the research scholars

4. ANALYSIS AND INTERRETATION

Table : 1
DISTRIBUTION OF RESPONDENTS BY THEIR GENDER

S.No	Gender	No. of respondent s (n:76)	Percent
1	Male	18	23.7
2	Female	58	76.3
3	Total	76	100

From the above table, it shows that majority of them are females 76.3% and 23.7% ofthem are males

Chart 1

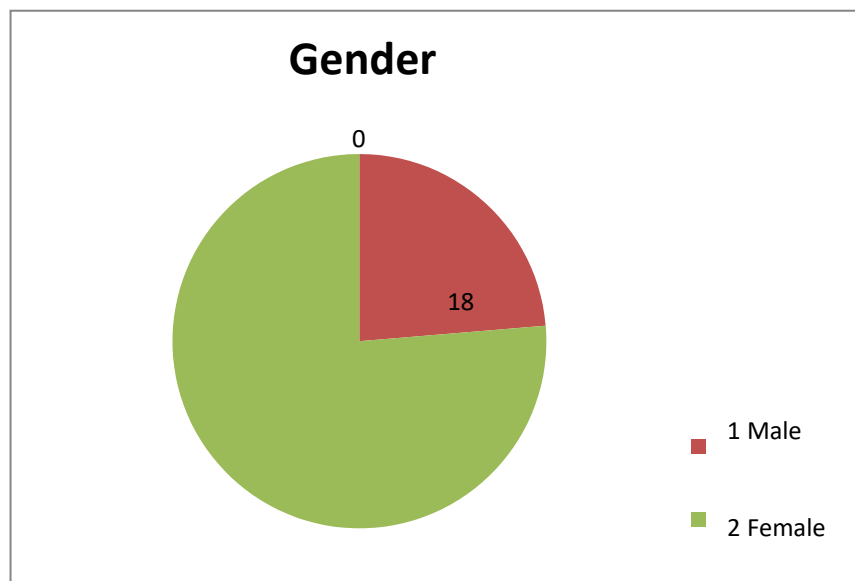


TABLE : 2

Distribution of respondents by their Department

S.No	Department	Frequency	Percentage
1	Science	44	57.9
2	Arts	32	42.1
3	Total	76	100

It shows more than half 58% of the respondents are from science background and less than 42% of the respondents are from the arts background.

TABLE : 3

Distribution of respondents by their Native

S.No	Nativity	Frequency	Percentage
1	Rural	27	35.5
2	Urban	41	53.9
3	Semi urban	8	10.5
4	Total	76	100

The nativity-wise analysis of respondents reveals that majority of them are urban area (53.9%), 35.5% of the respondents were from rural area and remain 10.5% of the respondents were from Semi-urban area.

Table : 4

Visit the library

S.No	Visit the Library	Frequency	Percentage
1	Almost daily	21	27.6
2	Twice a week	32	42.1
3	Once in a week	14	18.4
4	Once in two weeks	7	9.2
5	Rarely	2	2.6
6	Total	76	100

From the above table it is inferred that 42% of the respondents are using library twice a week, this is followed by 27.6% of the respondents are using almost daily, this is followed by 2.6% of the respondents are using library rarely.

Table : 5

ICT gadgets for accessing e-resources

S.No	ICT Gadgets	Frequency	Percentage
1	Laptop	51	67.1
2	Phone	24	31.6
3	I pad	1	1.3
4	Total	76	100

The above table shows that majority 67.1% of the respondents are using laptop, 31.6% of them are using phone and 1.3% of them are using as a ICT gadgets for a accessing e- resources.

Table : 6
Usage of E-resources mentioned in our college website

S.No	E-Resources	Frequency	Percentage
1	INFLIBNET	45	59.2
2	CEC	6	7.9
3	NDLI	25	32.9
4	Total	76	100

The above table shows that majority 59.2% of the respondents are using INFLIBNET and 32.9% of the respondents are using NDLI and 7.9% of the respondents are using CEC.

Table : 7
Awareness of the E resources

S.No	Awareness	Frequency	Percentage
1	By Yourself	27	35.5
2	Library staff	11	14.5
3	Faculty Members	25	32.9
4	Friends	13	17.1
5	Others	0	0
6	Total	76	100

The above table shows the awareness of E-resources. 35.5% of the respondents by themselves, 32.9% of the respondents by faculty members, and 17.1% of the respondents by friends 14.5% of the respondents by library staff members.

Table : 8
Level of Satisfaction for access e-resources

S.No	Level of Satisfaction	Frequency	Percentage
1	Strongly Satisfied	14	18.4
2	Satisfied	53	69.7
3	Neutral	9	11.8
4	Dissatisfied	0	0
5	Strongly Dissatisfied	0	0
6	Total	76	100

The table are shows the level of satisfaction for accessing e-resources respondents 69.7% satisfied, 18.4% of the respondents are strongly satisfied and 11.8% of the respondents are neutral.

5. FINDINGS AND CONCLUSION

Research Findings:

1. 76.3% of respondents are females.
2. 57.9% of respondents is belongs to faculty of science and 42.1% of respondents belongs to faculty of arts.
3. Nativity-wise analysis of respondents reveals that 53.9% are urban dwellers.
4. Majority 42.1% of respondents visit the library twice a week and 27.6% visit the library every day.
5. More over half of the respondents 67.1% access e-resources on their laptops and 31.6% use mobile phones to access e-resources.
6. The vast majority INFLIBNET is used by 59.2% of respondents, whereas NDLI is used by 32.9% of them.
7. The utilization of e-resources 35.5% of responders were by themselves 32.9% were by faculty

members and 17.1% were by friends.

8. The 88.1% of respondents are satisfied with e-resource access. 16. Slow access and connectivity were a concern for 53.9% of respondents while accessing e-resources.

Conclusion

E-resources are an essential component of today's education. The use of E-resources for diverse educational purposes is expanding. They can also foster creativity in research. These resources must be effectively managed and utilized. Regardless of how users choose to utilize the e-resources the availability and convenience of access to information encourages them to use E-resources more frequently. This study aids in identifying the areas that need to be examined and highlighted in order to provide enhanced E-resource access facilities to Bishop Heber College Library researchers.

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